SkillNavora · Business AI Stack

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Figma Design

A practical guide with steps, examples and a checklist. Read the chapter, then build the example.

DESIGN · COMPLETE GUIDE

Figma: design, components and handoff to developers

Figma is where product teams design screens together in the browser. This guide covers the tools you use every day, then builds one complete example: a lead-generation landing page with reusable components, responsive layouts, and a handoff that a developer can build from.

1. The Figma map

Area	What it is for
File and page	A file holds pages; each page holds frames (screens) and drafts.
Frame	A screen at a set size, for example 390 by 844 for a phone.
Auto layout	Rules that make a group resize and space itself, like flexbox. The most important skill in Figma.
Components and variants	A reusable element (button) with states (default, hover, disabled). Change the master, and every copy updates.
Variables	Named colours, spacing and text sizes, so a theme change is one edit.
Prototype	Links between frames that simulate the user flow.
Dev Mode	Shows measurements, CSS-like values and code snippets to developers.

2. Worked example: a lead-generation landing page

Goal: a visitor reads the offer, sees proof, and submits a short form. We design the mobile version first, then desktop.

1. **Set up the file.** Create a file `Landing page` with pages: *Foundations*, *Components*, *Screens*. Add a frame: 390 by 844, named `Mobile / Home`.
2. **Foundations.** Create variables: colour brand (#6C4CF5), text ink (#1D1640), surface (#F3F0FF); spacing 8, 16, 24; text sizes 14, 16, 22, 32.
3. **Components.** Build a *Button* with variants: Primary and Secondary, each with default and hover states; use auto layout with 16 px padding. Build an *Input* with states: empty, filled, error.
4. **Compose the mobile screen** with auto layout (vertical, 24 px gap): headline (one line of benefit), sub-headline, primary button, a proof row (three numbers), then the form (name, phone, need, consent), and a WhatsApp secondary button.
5. **Desktop.** Duplicate the frame to 1440 wide. Change the layout to two columns: copy on the left, form on the right. Components stay the same; only the layout changes.
6. **Prototype.** Link the button to a *Thank you* frame. Set the transition to Smart animate. Test on your phone with Figma Mobile.
7. **Handoff.** Open Dev Mode. Select the button and copy its spacing and colour values. Annotate edge cases: error text, empty states, the loading state of the submit button.

3. A design review checklist

- One primary action per screen.
- Text contrast at least 4.5:1 for body text.
- Touch targets at least 44 by 44 pixels.
- Every state designed: empty, loading, error, success.
- Names are clear (`Button / Primary / Hover`), so developers can find them.

4. From design to code

Developers can read values from Dev Mode, or use AI tools that generate code from a frame. Whatever you choose, check the output against the design at phone and desktop widths. Keep the component names the same in code and in Figma, so a change in one place is easy to find in the other.

5. Common mistakes

- Designing desktop first and forcing the phone layout later.

- Detached copies of components (paste instead of instance); a fix in the master does not update them.
- No states designed, so developers guess.

6. Checklist

- Variables for colours, spacing and type.
- Components with variants; auto layout everywhere.
- Phone and desktop frames; a clickable prototype.
- Dev Mode annotations for every state.

Figma's features, AI tools and plans change; check Figma's current help centre for the exact menu names.